

CHAUDHARY ZAHID ALI, CMA, ACCA

Strategic Finance & FP&A Professional | Financial Planning & Analysis | Budgeting & Forecasting | Finance Transformation
Riyadh / Khobar, Saudi Arabia | +966 50 413 1857 | czahidali@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/chaudhryzahidali/

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

CMA and ACCA-qualified Strategic Finance, FP&A, and Business Performance professional with 15+ years of experience across Saudi Arabia and the MENA region, helping leadership teams improve financial visibility, strengthen performance management, and make informed business decisions. Brings a boardroom-relevant blend of commercial finance, financial governance, commercial acumen, capital discipline, data analytics, business partnering, reporting automation, and digital finance transformation across large-scale retail, food and beverage franchising, transportation and mobility services, fuel and energy operations, financial consulting, and Big Four audit environments. Experienced in multi-year financial planning and analysis, budgeting, forecasting, management reporting, variance analysis, P&L and balance sheet analysis, cash flow and working capital management, capital investment appraisal, business valuation, feasibility studies, scenario modeling, KPI governance, executive dashboards, ERP-enabled reporting, internal controls, audit readiness, compliance, financial decision support, and Saudi taxation including VAT return preparation, Zakat computation, Corporate Tax compliance, E-Invoicing (Fatoora), ZATCA requirements, and tax compliance reporting. Recognized for repeatedly improving reporting efficiency, strengthening forecast reliability, enhancing executive visibility, supporting strategic planning and investment decisions, and translating complex financial and operational data into clear business insights that improve cost efficiency, protect margins, strengthen governance, and drive overall business performance.

CORE FINANCE & FP&A COMPETENCIES

- Financial Planning & Analysis (FP&A)
- Budgeting, Forecasting & Multi-Year Planning
- Management, Executive & Board Reporting
- Business Performance Management
- P&L, Balance Sheet & Cash Flow Analysis
- Working Capital & Liquidity Management
- Capital Investment Appraisal
- KPI Management & Performance Dashboards
- Financial Modeling, Scenario & Sensitivity Analysis
- Reporting Automation & Process Improvement
- Feasibility Studies & Business Valuation
- ERP & Financial Systems
- NPV, IRR, ROI, ROCE & Payback Analysis
- Cost Optimization & Resource Allocation
- Internal Controls, Audit Readiness & Compliance
- Financial Governance & Risk Management
- Commercial Finance & Business Partnering
- Stakeholder Management & Executive Comms
- IFRS-Compliant Financial Reporting
- Finance Leadership & Team Development
- Saudi Taxation (VAT, Zakat, Corporate Tax & ZATCA)
- Digital Finance Transformation

BUSINESS IMPACT

Repeatedly transformed reporting functions through automation, standardization and process improvement.

Reduced Group reporting time by 4 weeks through VBA-based models, automated workflows, and advanced data visualization.

Cut regional reporting by more than 10 days through standardized structures, workflow automation, and dashboard-led visibility.

Strengthened forecast discipline and budget-to-actual visibility via standardized forecasting, variance analysis & scenario modeling.

Supported investment and growth decisions via feasibility studies, sensitivity analysis, ROI, ROCE, NPV, IRR, and payback evaluation.

Improved executive decision support via KPI dashboards, Power BI reporting, benchmarking, and clearer management reporting.

Built the finance function from the ground up, partnering with PETRONAS directors and the Group CFO.

Partnered with business leaders to improve planning, investment decisions, operational performance, and financial visibility.

Enabled digital finance transformation using reporting automation, Power BI dashboards, VBA solutions, & standardized reporting.

Enabled executive decision-making through financial modeling, scenario analysis, benchmarking, and actionable business insights.

WORK EXPERIENCE

SIXT, SAMARA LAND TRANSPORTATION SERVICES CO. LTD. | Khobar, Saudi Arabia

Financial Planning, Analysis & Reporting Manager | Oct 2024 – Present

- **Mandate:** Lead FP&A, reporting, modeling, and decision support for planning, investments, and business performance.
- Build forecasts, models, KPI dashboards, and scenarios supporting leadership decisions and business planning.
- Provide Financial Appraisal, ROI, ROCE, cost, and performance analysis for projects, initiatives, and investments.
- Review cost structures, working capital, identify efficiencies, and support corrective action by performance monitoring.
- Strengthen executive visibility through benchmarking, management reporting, and finance-operations alignment.

INDEPENDENT FINANCIAL ADVISORY & FP&A CONSULTING | Islamabad, Pakistan

FP&A Consultant / Financial Planning, Analysis & Reporting Advisor | Dec 2021 – Jun 2024

- **Mandate:** Delivered FP&A, reporting, modeling, and advisory support across multiple client industries.
- Developed a multi-year strategic financial plan for a higher education institution for director-level decisions.
- Performed business valuation and feasibility analysis for clients across food and beverage and service industries.
- Developed budgets, forecasts, financial models, dashboards, and performance reports using Power BI and Excel.
- Conducted profitability, cost allocation, P&L, balance sheet, valuation, and scenario-based planning analysis.

PANDA GROUP, HEAD OFFICE | Saudi Arabia

Manager, Planning, Reporting & Operational Finance | Nov 2017 – Nov 2021

- **Mandate:** Managed planning, reporting, operational finance, and performance analysis for major regional retail group.
- Reduced reporting time by 20% through automated workflows, VBA models, MIS reporting and visualization.
- Managed capital investment evaluations & performed financial analysis for business initiatives & strategic projects.
- Managed strategic planning through multi-year business plans, annual budgets, rolling forecasts, and scenario modeling.
- Mentored finance teams in financial modeling, Excel, VBA, reporting tools, and analytics.

ALAMAR FOODS COMPANY, MASTER FRANCHISER OF DOMINO'S PIZZA | Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Group Reporting Manager | Nov 2015 – Nov 2017

- **Mandate:** Led group reporting, budgeting, forecasting, consolidation and performance analytics across KSA and MENAP.
- Reduced reporting preparation by 4 weeks through streamlining, automation, standardization, and visualization.
- Strengthened group management reporting through P&L analysis, balance sheet reviews, KPIs, and dashboards.
- Developed budgets, forecasts, and reporting frameworks supporting market planning and operational decisions.
- Evaluated business initiatives and project feasibility through ROI, NPV, IRR, financial impact, and viability analysis.

UNITED FUEL COMPANY, IN PARTNERSHIP WITH PETRONAS | Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Head of Accounting & Finance / Fractional CFO | Jun 2014 – Oct 2015

- **Mandate:** Established finance function across accounting, controls, reporting, budgeting, cash flow, and compliance.
- Built from ground up finance policies, controls, reporting processes, governance structures, and stakeholder relationships.
- Managed budgets, forecasts, cash flow & treasury management, feasibility, payroll, closings, month-end % year-end closing.
- Implemented Sage ERP and finance frameworks to improve control, reporting, and efficiency.
- Supported PETRONAS directors and Group CFO on planning, resource allocation, and operational decisions.

AZIZIA PANDA UNITED, HEAD OFFICE | Jeddah, Saudi Arabia

Assistant Manager, Planning & Reporting | Feb 2010 – Jun 2014

- **Mandate:** Supported planning, reporting, budgeting, analysis, KPIs, and performance monitoring.
- Prepared budget reviews, performance analysis, executive summaries, and management reporting for leadership.
- Supported budgeting and forecasting through data consolidation, variance analysis, and structured reporting.
- Improved financial visibility, reporting accuracy, & efficiency through VBA, financial modeling, & reporting automation

PWC | Islamabad, Pakistan

Supervising Senior, Audit & Assurance | Mar 2006 – Dec 2009

- **Mandate:** Delivered audit and assurance work across reporting, controls, compliance, and risk.
- Led audits covering financial statements, accounting records, controls, and compliance.
- Reviewed financial data, accounting treatments, documentation, and control processes for audit readiness.
- Supervised audit teams, reviewed workpapers, identified issues, and coordinated client communication.

TECHNICAL & FINANCE SYSTEMS

Excel | Power BI | DAX | VBA | Python | Oracle | SAP | Sage | PowerPoint

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

- CMA, USA, 2015
- MBA Executive, Finance, VU, 2018, CGPA: 3.75
- Saudi Taxation — VAT, Zakat & ZATCA Compliance
- ACCA, United Kingdom, 2005
- B-Com, University of the Punjab, Lahore, 2001
- Power BI for Financial Reporting & Dashboards

